

Welcome to Zillow Preferred

57 minutes including practice · 34 screens

Edition 2026-09-14-preferred-foundations-v4

Before you begin

Eric opens Rep, selects the training and existing agents across teams, confirms the timezone, and creates the session. The creator is the default presenter and follow-up coach. Keep the private presenter console on your screen and share the separate presentation window.

Ask each selected agent to open the session through their own existing login. No second invitation is needed. Confirm that everyone can join and see the current activity. Submit written work before showing the model. Short answers are ungraded: collect the learner's reasoning without requiring corrections, keywords, or a retry to continue. Record exercises still check saved actions. Open activities under presenter control; advancing leaves unfinished work available for catch-up. Show help requests and connection problems separately.

In self-paced study, notes remain in the learner's browser until they choose to share them. In a live session, the presenter sees submitted answers and progress; unsubmitted writing stays private. Preserve first attempts; a retry after an example is assisted.

For remote practice, use the meeting platform's breakout rooms. Assign pairs or trios and rotate agent, buyer, and observer. In pairs, the buyer gives feedback. Every agent needs a speaking turn, one correction, and a retry. If a partner is absent, assign a coach or leave the observation outstanding.

Follow Up Boss practice

Stay in the assigned TrueHQ session for the whole class. Every learner uses their own login and simulated record. The People list is a reference image: review the controls and submit a navigation explanation here. The simulator opens inside a contact; no separate Follow Up Boss account or training pond is needed. This walkthrough does not verify hands-on search. Arrange any coach-observed search check separately after class. Preserve the repair diagnosis step.

Coach where to click, save, and verify. The server check validates saved actions; it does not judge note usefulness. After a passed record changes, check it again. Each exercise is a separate scenario. Give everyone a first attempt and use the discussion to explore reasoning; do not stretch the lesson to fill a clock.

Choose the tool

Where	Use it for	When
Details -> Stage / Timeframe	Actual progress / buyer's stated timing	After a meaningful conversation or event; review automatic changes.
Create Note -> contact history	Facts, preferences, outcome and unknowns	Read before outreach; save context after it.
Right -> Tasks	Work owed, with an owner and due date	When you promise a callback or another next action.
Right -> Appointments	A confirmed meeting	When date, time and participants are agreed; check duplicates.
Right -> Files	Relevant approved documents	When needed under the team's document process.
Right -> Deals	Transaction details	At the team's transaction milestone; today's case is an accepted offer.
Right -> Collaborators	Team member access	When someone helps; also give them a task and handoff.
Relationships	A co-buyer or related contact	When relevant to the customer; not team access.
Right -> Action Plans / Automations	Existing system workflows	Check prior messages before personal outreach; team manages setup.
Left -> My Agent; right -> Zillow Insights	Relationship status and eligible browsing context	Before personalized outreach; confirm rather than assume.
Top -> Inbox / Tasks / Calendar	Conversations / commitments / scheduled events	Start-of-day review, then update as work happens.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

Facilitator flow

01 / 34 · 0-1 min · Welcome to Preferred

Welcome to Zillow Preferred

Start with the Zillow program and its requirements before opening the Follow Up Boss examples. Confirm that everyone has joined their assigned TrueHQ session. Share the separate presentation window and keep your presenter console private. Explain any unfamiliar terms. Let each person answer and practice on their own screen. Written responses are for discussion, with no required keywords or corrections. Before class, create a new session with this updated lesson; existing sessions keep the lesson they were created with.

Zillow Preferred

How the program works, your agent agreement, ZIP preferences, monthly lead capacity, and the performance standards you must meet.

Follow Up Boss

How to find a contact, read the history, make calls and send texts, and use stages, notes, tasks, and appointments. We will also cover My Agent, Zillow Insights, and Smart Actions.

Practice and next steps

Work through realistic cases, decide when to use nurture, and learn how to record an accepted offer. Finish by checking what you still need before leads begin.

Stay in your own TrueHQ live session for today's exercises. The practice records are built into this session. Your written answers help us understand your thinking; they do not block you from continuing.

Ask the room: Can everyone see this session in their own TrueHQ account?

02 / 34 · 1-2 min · Welcome to Preferred

How Zillow Preferred works

Explain the value of a Zillow connection without promising a closing or a fixed number of leads. Preferred and the Premier Agent app are not contradictory names: the app still supports the program. Introduce Day 1 as program readiness plus the working contact record; Days 2-4 deepen conversations, showings, and financing.

The program

Zillow Preferred is an invitation-only program, previously called Flex. Zillow connects you with potential buyers. A success fee applies when a transaction covered by your agreement closes. Review that agreement with your team.

Your role

Be available, understand the customer's request, agree on a useful next step, and keep the record current. The customer may be new to buying and may not know who is calling.

Growth

Your performance and the areas you serve help determine how many leads you receive. Tell the team how many new leads you can handle each month. That number is your capacity, not a guaranteed number of leads.

Official reference: [Zillow Preferred](#)

Ask the room: What does the customer need from you that an automatic message cannot provide?

Before your lead funnel turns on

Eric's activation workflow requires the agent agreement. Show the actual invitation/account path only during a designated setup check, outside the simulated exercises. Zillow's public routing documentation describes team-managed controls; do not promise every agent an identical edit menu. Academy onboarding requires login and was not independently inspected. Confirm each learner's agreement, ZIP preferences, monthly capacity, and activation status with the team.

Agreement & account

Use your Zillow onboarding invitation and your own account. Complete the Zillow Preferred agent agreement and required onboarding. Ask the team to verify activation; completing this class alone does not activate routing.

ZIP preferences

When you log in for onboarding, set the ZIP preferences available to you. Choose areas you can serve well. Confirm your final routed ZIPs with the team lead; preferences and team routing must agree.

Capacity & availability

Tell the team how many NEW connections per month you can responsibly handle alongside existing clients. Confirm that number and your availability before leads begin.

Official reference: [Program policies](#) · [Agent capacity & routing](#) · [Program benefits](#)

Ask the room: If your agreement is complete but the wrong ZIPs are routed, are you ready for leads?

Choose capacity you can actually serve

Ask learners to justify a capacity conversation, not calculate a magic number. The team lead can inspect Zillow.com -> Agent Hub -> Profile -> Team -> Agent capacity & lead routing; ZIPs, lead types, pause and new monthly connection capacity live there. Agent communicates realistic capacity and changes. Delivery depends on available demand, eligibility, geography and performance. Never teach capacity as a guaranteed order or advise adding inappropriate ZIPs.

Coverage and capacity

Sam has six active buyers, two evening showing blocks, and a day job on Tuesdays. Sam knows Olympia and Lacey well, but is considering distant ZIPs to receive more leads. Sam wants 20 new connections per month and assumes Zillow will deliver exactly 20.

Sam can answer calls during several daytime windows, but has no coverage arranged for Tuesday. Think about driving time, first conversations, showings, and weeks of follow-up - not just how many new names fit in a list.

Official reference: [Agent capacity & routing](#)

Ask the room: Which part of Sam's plan would you discuss before activation?

Participant task: What would you change or clarify with Sam about ZIPs, availability, and monthly capacity?

- What would you change or clarify with Sam about ZIPs, availability, and monthly capacity?

The standards you must meet

Open a demonstration report only after removing private agent performance. Explain pCVR is not a promise that four of the next hundred close, and new agents should ask how their report is established. Example: 10 answered of 40 incoming attempts = 25%; it is the minimum, not a target to miss the other calls. FUB use and current status reporting are required; team operational and seller-specific standards also apply to the enrolled team. Do not change stages to improve appearance. State clearly that FUB usage, calling through FUB, and texting through FUB are mandatory. Show where to check the numbers later: Reporting -> Zillow Performance Report. The pCVR model considers market results and conversion and volume over 180 days, with more weight on the most recent 90 days.

4%+

Predicted conversion

Zillow estimates how likely your connections are to become closings. This is called predicted conversion rate, or pCVR. Keep it at 4% or higher.

25%+

Pickup rate

Answer at least 25% of incoming Zillow connection calls over the last 90 days. For example, answering 10 of 40 incoming calls is 25%. This does not measure how often buyers answer your calls.

Follow Up Boss is mandatory

Use Follow Up Boss to work your leads and keep their records current. All lead calls and texts must go through Follow Up Boss so the communication is saved on the contact record.

Meet 100% of your assigned Zillow Home Loans pre-approval target over three months. Ask your team lead what your target is. We cover lender introductions and buyer choice on Day 4.

Official reference: [Program standards](#) · [Performance report](#)

Ask the room: If ten buyers answer forty outbound calls, have you established Zillow's pickup rate?

Now, let's open Follow Up Boss

All class exercises remain in TrueHQ. This page teaches the real login path for the later readiness check. Never ask for passwords on screen. Have each learner verify real account access before activation and observe one search separately; completion here is not proof of live-system navigation. Confirm the team-approved email account and notification setup.

For this class, keep working in the TrueHQ simulator. These are the steps you will use in your real Follow Up Boss account after training.

Account setup

Confirm the correct team, name, phone and notifications. In your profile menu -> My Settings, connect the approved email/calendar account. Confirm FUB calling and mobile access with the team.

People · Inbox

People finds contacts and groups needing outreach. Inbox holds conversations that need your attention. Clicking a contact's name opens their record.

Tasks · Calendar · Reporting

Tasks tracks work owed; Calendar shows scheduled time; Reporting shows results. Admin settings belong to the team's setup process. You do not need to configure lead flow during a customer call.

Official reference: [Email & calendar setup](#) · [Inbox](#) · [Tasks](#)

Ask the room: Which screen would you open for an unread reply? Which for a promised callback?

07 / 34 · 7-8 min · Getting started in Follow Up Boss

Start in People

Stay in TrueHQ. The full reference image is already displayed on this page; scroll to inspect its controls. Point out People, search, smart lists, and filtering. Ask learners which controls they would use and how they would confirm the source and recent activity. This is a walkthrough, not a completed search task. The simulator begins inside a contact; no external account is needed for class.

Use the original product reference in the presentation.

Ask the room: Which control would you use to find a contact by name?

08 / 34 · 8-9 min · Getting started in Follow Up Boss

Explain how you would find Avery

Give everyone a quiet first attempt. For a beginner, explain that People is the contact list, Source is where the inquiry came from, and Assigned to is the person responsible for follow-up. Ask an experienced learner what they would verify if there were two Averys or the owner had changed. The image reads Training Source; do not ask them to find a Zillow label that is not shown. Collect the written reasoning without scoring or requiring a rewrite. This is a reference walkthrough, not verified hands-on search; a separate coach-observed navigation check can happen after class.

A name is a starting point, not an identity check

You are covering for Alex Rivera. A message says: "Avery wants to compare 406 and 422 Juniper." You have a name and two property addresses, but you have not spoken with Avery yourself.

The People reference shows Avery Morgan assigned to Alex. The source under the name reads "Training Source" because this is a fictional training image. In a real record, Source tells you where the contact came from; Assigned to tells you who owns the follow-up. Do not assume a record says Zillow just because this is a Zillow class.

Your task is to explain where you would start and which details you would compare before changing anything. If two people had the same first name, what would stop you from editing the wrong person? You do not need to perform a search outside this session.

Ask the room: Explain the path you would take, then submit your own answer here.

Participant task: Explain how you would identify the right Avery before editing. Use the reference and the covering-agent scenario.

- Where would you start, which details would you compare, and what would you do if the name alone did not identify the right person?

Find the tools on a contact record

Let each person explore at least Tasks, Appointments, and Collaborators before explaining the difference. The screenshot is a fictional record; the transparent hotspots identify tools without replacing FUB controls. Locations can differ in current accounts because sections can be reordered. Ask beginners to point, then experienced learners to explain the handoff. My Agent status is on the left; current Zillow Insights is on the right.

Ask the room: Where would you record a promise to call, versus a confirmed showing?

Check the Details panel

Use this reference image to point out Stage, Assigned, Source, and Timeframe. The image itself is not editable. Timing should come from the buyer, not a guess. On the next exercise, demonstrate the stage menu and green save check in the simulator, then let every learner attempt the task on their own screen. Use the preceding interactive map to locate these fields at native resolution; avoid enlarged low-resolution crops.

Stage

What has actually happened: spoke, agreed an appointment, met, or progressed further. Use the left Details panel, choose the stage, and save the change.

Source & owner

Source identifies where the inquiry came from. Assigned to identifies responsibility. Verify both before changing a record.

Timeframe

When the buyer says they may move. A later move date does not tell you whether they want to see homes now.

Official reference: [Contact record](#)

Ask the room: A buyer says “Saturday might work.” What else would you need to know before calling it an appointment?

The welcome text has already gone out

The initial automated text is Eric’s team workflow, not a universal Zillow default. Confirm its actual sender, content and trigger before class. Do not invent the exact text or send duplicate greetings. Demonstrate where calls/texts appear in the timeline. Explain the difference between an answered connection, a tour request, and an activity notification. Record the actual result, not the label you hoped to reach.

On arrival

TRU sends an automated initial text. Read the contact history to understand the inquiry and prior messages. An automated greeting does not mean you spoke with the buyer.

Your outreach

Use FUB’s calling or texting controls on the record so communication is captured. Introduce yourself, your brokerage and the Zillow request. Invite an appropriate next step; listen before assuming readiness.

After the call

Save the outcome and context, confirm the true stage/timeframe, and create the next task or agreed appointment. Make your calls and send your texts through FUB. If a customer reaches you elsewhere, record what happened and continue the follow-up through FUB.

TRU standard: at least five unique personal calls or texts in the first seven days from arrival. Automated messages and emails do not count; day seven is not a stop rule.

Official reference: [Contact record](#) · [Action Plans](#)

Ask the room: An automatic text and a property view appear. What evidence of a personal conversation do you have?

12 / 34 · 13-16 min · Work the connection

Practice: save the appointment stage

Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise's scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Complete this case on your own screen, save, and check your work.

Participant task: Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

13 / 34 · 16-18 min · Work the connection

Recognize Smart Actions after a call

These are original official FUB help images, including their original colors and sample content. They are reference examples, not an exercise answer or a live SMS. Beta requires FUB Calling, call recording, active Zillow two-way integration and supported Zillow stages. Admin -> AI Settings controls suggest-only versus automatic behavior: early stages and appointments can be automatic; timeframe is always automatic. Verify team mode before demonstrating. Do not imply every learner receives the same prompt after every call.

Use the original product reference in the presentation.

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After an eligible FUB call, Smart Actions may suggest a stage or appointment by text. Review the customer, action, and date before approving. Timeframe changes are automatic. No text does not mean there is no follow-up to do.

Official reference: [Smart Actions](#)

Ask the room: What would you verify before answering Yes?

14 / 34 · 18-19 min · Work the connection

Check what Smart Actions changed

Preserve the learner's answer without marking an opinion wrong. Discuss evidence after submission. Do not reply STOP to Smart Actions texts or block that number: it can stop other FUB texts including lead alerts. Use notification settings and ask the team for help. No suggestion is a reason to leave an inaccurate record.

“Friday could work” is not a confirmed meeting

Jamie says Friday afternoon might work, but needs to check with a partner. No time or property is agreed. A Smart Actions message suggests an appointment for Friday at 3. You also notice the move timeframe changed.

You still owe Jamie a call tomorrow. Inspect the proposed action and the actual conversation. Decide what to accept, decline, or correct, and what work remains yours.

Use the original product reference in the presentation.

Look for the purple update marker and change log. Check Appointments for duplicates; appointments created by FUB identify that in the description. Keep using the manual record controls when needed.

Official reference: [Smart Actions](#)

Ask the room: What should the record say until Jamie confirms?

Participant task: What would you do with the suggestion, the changed timeframe, and tomorrow's follow-up?

- What would you do with the suggestion, the changed timeframe, and tomorrow's follow-up?

15 / 34 · 19-20 min · My Agent

What My Agent means

Differentiate Preferred's initial 180 days from other Premier Agent configurations. FUB needs the Zillow two-way integration. Do not promise all search history, all internet activity, or permanent exclusive lead ownership. Explain the invitation/renewal state and ask the team to troubleshoot a missing relationship. A CRM connected status is not a signed representation contract.

Where to check

Open the contact -> Details -> My Agent status. This tells you whether the Zillow relationship is active, waiting for a response, or ending. The contact's stage tells you where you are in the buying process.

Why it matters

While the relationship is active, Zillow shows you as the customer's agent and can share their Zillow home-search activity with you. Check the expiration date. The customer can end this connection before the 180 days are up.

How to use it

Use what the customer is exploring to ask a better question and offer useful help. Maintain a real conversation. My Agent does not replace the required buyer or touring agreement.

Official reference: [My Agent](#) · [Touring agreements](#)

Ask the room: Can My Agent be Connected while the stage is still Attempted Contact?

16 / 34 · 20-22 min · My Agent

See what the buyer is viewing on Zillow

Current Zillow Insights replaces the older Buyer Insights panel and is shown for eligible contacts with the active My Agent relationship. The simulator's older screenshot has an Activity section; explain the difference so agents recognize the current label. FUB may show patterns, saved/viewed homes and recent searches; this is not all internet history. Do not announce surveillance or treat a high-intent label as consent or a financial fact.

Use the original product reference in the presentation.

A change worth asking about

Last Tuesday, Taylor said a three-bedroom home near work mattered most, but had not settled on a budget. Today, eligible Zillow activity shows saved homes in another ZIP and a higher price range.

You have no new reply from Taylor. A partner might be browsing, or the criteria might have changed. You do not know yet.

Look at the date range and the actual saved/viewed homes. Offer a useful comparison and ask whether the search has changed. Treat the price range as browsing context, not approved purchasing power.

Official reference: [Zillow Insights](#)

Ask the room: What do you know, what are you inferring, and how would you ask?

Participant task: Write one useful outreach question for Taylor and identify one assumption you would avoid.

- Write one useful outreach question for Taylor and identify one assumption you would avoid.

17 / 34 · 22-23 min · Record practice

Write what the next agent needs

Read the buyer facts first. Let learners identify what the vague note loses before comparing the fuller note. Explain that the next exercise supplies wording to teach where to save a note; that is practice with the controls, not a writing test. For experienced learners, ask what they would ask on the next call without treating unknown financing or availability as established facts. Collect different ideas; do not require the group to copy one preferred opinion.

Avery answered, but no meeting was discussed

In this separate practice case, Avery is buying with their sister and looking in Olympia or Lacey for at least three bedrooms before November. Avery asked for a couple of options. You agreed to send two homes by Thursday. You do not know their budget, financing position, or availability for a showing.

Compare two notes. "Talked. Interested. Follow up later." tells a teammate almost nothing. "Spoke with Avery. Buying with their sister; Olympia or Lacey; 3+ bedrooms; before November. Agreed to send two options by Thursday. No meeting discussed." preserves the facts and the promise.

What would you still need to ask Avery? Which details could you safely put in the note now, and which would be guesses? A note records the conversation; a task reminds someone to do the next action.

Ask the room: If you inherited only "Talked. Interested," what might you get wrong on the next call?

18 / 34 · 23-26 min · Record practice

Practice: write the conversation note

Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise's scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Complete this case on your own screen, save, and check your work.

Participant task: Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

Give the follow-up a date and time

For beginners, distinguish a saved note from a scheduled reminder. A note alone will not put the action on the task list. The missed-call exercise uses a fictional next-day plan; do not present this as a universal contact cadence. For experienced learners, discuss how to hand the task to a covering agent without losing context. There is no required wording for the discussion.

A missed call still leaves work to do

Avery's inquiry arrived this morning. You called at 9:10 a.m., nobody answered, and you left a voicemail. There is no conversation or appointment to record. You plan another call tomorrow morning; that timing is this exercise's plan, not a rule for every lead.

"Follow up" leaves the next person guessing. "Call Avery tomorrow at 9:30 a.m. about the home inquiry; if reached, offer a showing time" names an action and a time. The assigned agent owns the task. The note records today's attempt; the task schedules tomorrow's action.

Suppose you cannot work tomorrow morning. What would need to change so the promise does not disappear? Explain who would own the task and what they would need to read first.

Ask the room: What does "follow up" fail to tell the person who sees it tomorrow?

Decide where each update belongs

Collect the reasoning, then point back to the record map: note for context, appointment for meeting, task with owner/date for parking, collaborator/access plus explicit handoff for teammate, relationship for co-buyer, Files per document process. No accepted-offer deal is required in this case; do not teach creating a Deal as a mandatory step after every call. A task assignment alone does not grant contact access.

A covering agent needs a usable handoff

Avery agrees to tour 406 Juniper on Saturday at 11. You promised to check parking with the listing agent tomorrow. A teammate will cover the showing and needs access to Avery's background. Avery's sister is a co-buyer, not a member of your team. You also received a relevant approved document.

You need to preserve the buyer's preferences, record the meeting, assign your parking follow-up, and prepare the covering agent. No offer has been accepted.

Official reference: [Contact record](#) · [Tasks](#)

Ask the room: Which tools do different jobs even when they refer to the same showing?

Participant task: Where would you put each part of the handoff, and what would you leave for later?

- Where would you put each part of the handoff, and what would you leave for later?

Practice: set the missed-call task

Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise's scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Complete this case on your own screen, save, and check your work.

Participant task: Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

Define nurture: two different decisions

Give everyone quiet reading time and an independent response before discussion. For beginners, explain lead, stage, task, and automatic versus personal outreach using the facts on screen. Compare two different responses; ask "Which fact led you there?" rather than requiring a corrected answer. Explain the team's actual nurture rule and why it applies. Do not invent a timeline or imply that a later move date or silence automatically means Nurture. Maya has an agreed call due; ask what the learner would clarify before changing the relationship. Jordan has two personal attempts in the first week, not three: the automatic message does not count. TRU's first-week floor is at least five unique personal attempts from arrival; calls, including voicemail, and personal texts count. Do not turn that floor into a stop rule or impose a standard beyond week one. For experienced learners, use the changed-fact questions and ask what happens to an existing task if the stage changes. All written responses are ungraded; no rewrite is required to continue.

First, the terms: Nurture usually means staying in touch with someone who may buy later, using a follow-up plan that fits their needs. Your coach will explain when your team uses this stage. Moving a name into a different stage does not, by itself, create a follow-up plan. A task is the dated reminder assigned to the person who will take the next action.

Maya Chen · The move is later, but there is a promise due

How it started: Maya requested a tour through Zillow three weeks ago. You spoke and toured one home together. She is renting until March and said, "I probably won't move before my lease ends, but I want to understand the neighborhoods before I choose."

What happened this week: On Tuesday she sent two listings and asked which area would make the commute easier. You agreed to call Friday at 4 p.m. She replied, "Yes, talk then." She has not asked to stop hearing from you, and no second showing is booked.

What you inherit: The stage is Met with customer. A Friday 4 p.m. call task is assigned to you. A covering agent added, "Six months out - move to Nurture?" You have not discussed how often Maya wants contact or whether she would consider a suitable home sooner.

The decision: It is Friday at 3:45 p.m. Would you change the stage now, keep it while you clarify something, or take another step? What would you ask on the agreed call? Explain how your plan respects her timing and the promise already made.

Jordan Ellis • The record is quiet, but look at the attempts

How it started: Jordan requested information about 18 Cedar Street through Zillow on Monday morning. You called that morning, reached voicemail, and left a message offering to arrange a showing. You have never spoken with Jordan.

What happened this week: An automatic welcome text went out Monday. On Wednesday you personally texted, “I can help arrange a visit to Cedar Street - would Thursday afternoon or Saturday morning work?” There has been no reply. The record shows two property views on Thursday; it does not explain why Jordan viewed them.

What you inherit: It is Friday. The stage is Attempted contact. There is no next task. Another agent wrote, “No response - maybe not serious. Nurture?” The history contains one personal call and one personal text; the automatic message is separate.

The decision: What can you fairly conclude about Jordan’s interest? What would you do before treating this as a longer-term relationship? Choose a next attempt that offers a reason to respond, and explain when you would review the result. You do not know whether Jordan is busy, already helped, or no longer looking.

Ready for a harder question? How would your plan change if Maya asked for one call next month instead of Friday, or Jordan replied, “We bought yesterday”? Identify which new fact changes the action. Do not invent a universal number of days for moving someone to Nurture.

Ask the room: Which fact matters most to your next action, and which tempting conclusion is not supported yet?

Participant task: For Maya and Jordan, separate what you know from what you are assuming. Explain the next action you would take and why.

- For each buyer, what do you know from the record, what is still unknown, and would you change the stage yet? Explain your reasoning.
- What would you do next for each buyer? Include what you would say or ask, who owns the action, and when you would do it.
- What new information would make you change your plan? Name a specific answer or event, and when you would review the record.

Coach-led discussion. No automatic grade. Explain the team rule and ask for evidence; do not invent a nurture timeline.

23 / 34 • 39-40 min • Record practice

Repair Avery’s record

Give learners time to read, not just react to a stage label. Beginners can start with “What happened?” and “What still has to happen?” Experienced learners should explain the downstream cost: a teammate could prepare for an unconfirmed appointment or miss the needed call. Preserve the next exercise’s diagnosis step. Discussion has no keyword score; record controls still check saved actions.

A hopeful plan became an appointment label

Yesterday Avery called about 406 and 422 Juniper Lane. Avery said, “Let’s plan on Thursday morning - I’ll confirm once I’ve checked with my sister.” No appointment was booked. You are now covering for the agent who took the call.

The record says Appointment set. The saved note says, “Talked. Interested. Follow up later.” There is no next task. Avery’s interest in the two properties is visible, but the note does not tell the next caller which homes were discussed or what confirmation is still needed.

Before you edit, decide what the record claims, what the buyer actually confirmed, and what another agent needs next. In the following exercise, identify the record's problems first, then make your changes. Do not create a meeting just to make the label look right.

Ask the room: What could the next agent mistakenly believe, and what would you need to clarify with Avery?

24 / 34 · 40-44 min · Record practice

Practice: repair Avery's record

Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise's scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Complete this case on your own screen, save, and check your work.

Participant task: Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

25 / 34 · 44-45 min · Record practice

Check the record before moving on

Ask agents to check their own work. Introduce the deal exercise: once an offer is accepted, update the stage and record the deal details.

Stage

Does it match the event, and did the change save?

Note

Does it explain what happened without guessing?

Task

Is the next action scheduled for a real date and time?

Handoff

Could another agent act on this record without asking you to explain it?

The handoff test

You will be unavailable when the next task is due. Your teammate has only this record. Could they identify the buyer's request, what was actually agreed, and the action they own? If not, name the missing fact rather than adding a more optimistic stage.

Ask the room: Which check would catch an unsaved stage?

26 / 34 · 45-46 min · Daily workflow

Handle a reply from start to finish

Demonstrate missed calls, texts and emails as conversations. If a customer asks you to stop contacting them, respect the request and follow the team's communication process; do not solve it by changing a stage alone. Inbox permission is different from contact assignment. Do not let a cleared Inbox stand in for promised tasks.

Read the whole thread

Check My Inbox and the team inboxes assigned to you. Match the person before replying. Unread is a viewing state; opening a message does not complete the customer's request.

Preserve the outcome

Save important customer context on the contact record. An internal Inbox note stays in the conversation and is not added to the lead profile. A draft has not been sent.

Finish or hand off

Reply, handle the request or assign follow-up with an owner and due date. Close the conversation after handling it. Read status or closing an Inbox item does not update the contact stage.

Official reference: [Inbox](#)

Ask the room: A teammate sees an empty contact timeline but you wrote an Inbox note. Where should the customer context go?

27 / 34 · 46-47 min · Daily workflow

Use Smart Lists and tasks together

New users: explain dynamic list with a concrete example, such as contacts with no recent communication. Experienced users: ask how a stale stage or automation could affect a filter. Avoid building or editing shared lists during class. Missing contact: clear filters, check All People/search, then ask the team about assigned/collaborator/pond access before creating a duplicate.

Inbox + due work

Handle incoming replies, missed calls and due/overdue commitments. Confirm today's appointments. A specific promise needs a dated task and an owner.

People -> Smart Lists

Saved filters identify contacts by criteria such as stage or last communication. They update as records change. Use the team's assigned lists; inspect filters if someone is missing.

Read before contacting

Confirm identity, source, owner, last conversation, recent activity and next task. Being absent from a list does not prove follow-up is done; access and filters affect what you see.

Official reference: [Smart Lists](#) · [Tasks](#)

Ask the room: Why might Avery disappear from a Smart List without being deleted?

28 / 34 · 47-49 min · Transaction handoff

Practice adding a deal

Demonstrate this in-session deal form with fictional details. It is a warm-up, not a submitted record check. Every learner then completes the accepted-offer record exercise in their own session; that exercise saves and checks the required deal actions. For new agents, a deal is the transaction record: the property, agreed price, and expected close date. An inspection is a later scheduled event; it does not replace the current contract status. Introduce the separate Elena case before learners read the email. For experienced agents, ask what they would verify rather than assuming the inspection date is the only remaining obligation.

Ask the room: What would you check before creating this deal?

29 / 34 · 49-52 min · Transaction handoff

Practice: record the accepted offer

Open this activity for the learners. Each person works in their own simulated record inside this TrueHQ session; do not open Follow Up Boss or repeat the update in another account. Read this exercise's scenario: each is a separate fictional case, so changes do not carry into the next case. Let the learner find the control before offering a hint. Preserve the repair diagnosis step where present. Save and check the work here; in a live session the check submits the result to the presenter. A passed check validates the required saved actions, not note quality or overall readiness. Reopen and verify changes, and check again after editing a passed record.

Ask the room: Complete this case on your own screen, save, and check your work.

Participant task: Work in the simulated record below. Save your changes, then check your work here.

30 / 34 · 52-53 min · Transaction handoff

What to do after an offer is accepted

Explain the success fee as a signed-agreement obligation, not a universal flat rate. Zillow's current compliance page requires closing documents within four calendar days for eligible transactions; the team must name the responsible coordinator and handoff. FUB is the daily CRM, while Zillow remains necessary for this reporting and onboarding. Seller-connection agents need their additional program training; Day 1 does not certify seller-course completion.

In Follow Up Boss

Record the actual stage, accepted-offer details, deal and next task under the team's process. Keep the transaction coordinator informed about changes.

In Zillow Premier Agent

Final transaction details and closing documents still need the Zillow workflow. A FUB Deal or file alone does not finish Zillow reporting.

Know who owns it

Confirm who logs the transaction, uploads closing documents and handles the success fee. Escalate a pre-existing-relationship or referral question promptly; do not assume it removes an obligation.

Official reference: [Program standards](#) · [Program policies](#)

Ask the room: If the FUB deal says Closed, what still needs verification?

31 / 34 · 53-54 min · Ready for leads

Where will you start tomorrow?

Give an independent response before hearing an experienced agent. Invite different priorities and ask for the reasoning. The case does not specify lead age, staffing, or urgency beyond the promised call, so acknowledge a learner who identifies those unknowns. Do not grade their opinion or require a preferred sequence. This is rehearsal inside TrueHQ; actual client work happens after class.

Your first five minutes back at work

You open the task list and see a promised buyer call due in ten minutes, a new inquiry with no attempt logged, and an older record whose note says only "follow up." A colleague can help, but needs to know what to do.

Explain how you would organize these actions without letting one vanish. You may ask for missing information. There is no single required order: state what you would check, what you would act on, and how you would make responsibility clear.

Ask the room: What would you do, what would you ask, and how would you prevent the other actions from disappearing?

Participant task: Plan the next actions for the three records. Explain your priorities and what you would need to check.

- What would you handle first, what would you check or delegate, and what belongs in each record so nothing is lost?

32 / 34 · 54-55 min · Ready for leads

Before your next client conversation

In live sessions, closing the session creates 24-hour recall, three-day fresh-case, and seven-day coach-review assignments. Confirm each agent's named coach and session timezone. Agents see due work in Rep; the daily digest links to due or reviewable work. In self-paced study, arrange these checks with a coach. Without a relevant client opportunity, use a fresh fictional case and label real-work application not yet observed. Practice readiness is separate from quiz certification and activation.

After each conversation

Save the true stage, factual note, and dated next action before moving on.

With your coach

Review a real record together after the next relevant client conversation.

Ask the room: Tell your partner what you will practice and when.

Participant task: Make the record update part of finishing the conversation.

- After my next call, I will complete ____ before moving on.
- My next follow-up block starts in ____.
- My named coach and the example we will review.

33 / 34 · 55-56 min · Ready for leads

Before you start receiving leads

End the simulated class here. Arrange a separate, coach-observed real-account check before turning on leads; use an approved test contact, not edits to a real buyer. Record unresolved access/setup questions for the team. Do not mark agreement signed, ZIPs saved or activation complete based on this written answer. New saved sessions must use this edition.

Zillow ready

Agreement and onboarding complete. ZIP preferences reviewed. Monthly capacity and availability confirmed with the team. Routing activation verified.

FUB ready

Own login works. Calling and texting through FUB work. Notifications and your approved email/calendar are checked. Find a contact, locate its tools, and understand the connected Zillow report.

Work ready

Read the history. Call or text through FUB. Save a clear note, the correct stage, and the next task or appointment. Check automatic updates against what the buyer actually said.

Ask the room: What is the one unresolved item that could prevent you from handling your first connection?

Participant task: What is ready, what remains uncertain, and who will help you resolve it before leads begin?

- What is ready, what remains uncertain, and who will help you resolve it before leads begin?

34 / 34 · 56-57 min · Ready for leads

Your reference desk

Sources reviewed September 13, 2026. Use the live official pages for updates. Team-specific onboarding invitations, ZIP edit rights, routing allocations, automation text and Smart Actions mode must be checked in the actual account. Public Zillow Academy onboarding is login-protected; no completion claims are made. Coach new agents on the needed task instead of asking them to read every linked article.

Official reference: [Zillow Preferred](#)

Official reference: [Program standards](#)

Official reference: [Agent capacity & routing](#)

Official reference: [Program benefits](#)

Official reference: [Program policies](#)

Official reference: [Smart Actions](#)

Official reference: [My Agent](#)

Official reference: [Zillow Insights](#)

Official reference: [Contact record](#)

Official reference: [Inbox](#)

Official reference: [Smart Lists](#)

Official reference: [Tasks](#)

Official reference: [Email & calendar setup](#)

Official reference: [Performance report](#)

Official reference: [Action Plans](#)

Official reference: [Touring agreements](#)

Ask the room: Which reference would you use when an expected Smart Actions text does not arrive?

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References and certification

Updated September 13, 2026 from the existing Day 1 workshop and Eric's approved interactive-training plan. TRU sales doctrine remains the source for coaching the first call and follow-up.

- [Zillow Preferred FAQ](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Preferred Program Standards](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Agent Capacity and Lead Routing](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Preferred Program Benefits](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Preferred Compliance Policies](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Smart Actions](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [My Agent Status](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Insights in Follow Up Boss](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Lead Profile Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Inbox Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Smart Lists Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Tasks Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Connecting Your Email & Calendar](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Preferred Agent Performance Report](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Action Plans Overview](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13
- [Zillow Touring Agreement](#) - official reference, reviewed 2026-09-13

Existing quizzes, pass thresholds, and certification records continue through the normal Rep course flow. The presentation link is not a certification attempt.